

Promises and Pressure: The Trial Run

承诺与压力：第一次试行

Theme: 友谊、家庭与人际关系 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6, 127

English Story

The trial run for the third arc had one subject: **care**. A **home-care worker**, a night nurse, and a **housewife** who had raised four children agreed to be interviewed by **people** who had never done any of those things. “You want to know what **love** costs,” the **worker** said. “Write it in a **file**, then come and do a shift.” No one had measured what **care** cost in the **home**.

A **patient** in the ward had a photograph of her husband in a black **suit**; an old **copper** coin, a **bottle** of medicine, and a white envelope sat on the **cabinet** beside her. “He was an **agent** for a textile company,” she said. “He had a **lovely** laugh and a lot of debts.” The **strike** at the plant **that** winter was the only thing in her **file** **that** anyone had bothered to record.

The interview drifted toward **inheritance**: what a mother passes to a daughter, what a father cannot pass at all. “A **child** is not **stock**,” she said. “And a marriage is not an **alliance**.” Her own **intimacy** with her husband had survived **exile** from the south, an empty **counter**, and a queue for everything.

Her **companion** in the next bed was a former teacher; his **buddy** came every Thursday with a **lamb** stew and a paper **tag** on the container. “A **friend** is not a **limb**,” she said. “You cannot cut one off and call the rest whole.” The **terror** of the empty chair was **familiar** to everyone in the ward, and the **hostility** of the young nurse toward tears was, in its own way, an **affection**. She held his **arm** like a professional.

A **woman** from the city **cabinet** arrived to **represent** the council, wearing a **suit** and carrying a **lens** in a leather case. “Tell me what you found,” she said. “**That** is what we know: one **pulse**, one **queen**, one **snake** in the grass.” Her **pulse** was steady; her **tail**, as she left, was a cold goodbye. “Since you asked,” Maya said, “we found **that** **people** **care** whether the person writing the **file** can imagine their life.” A line of chairs, a single **emotion** on every face: this was the evidence nobody had asked for. One **ally** in the **cabinet** was often enough; when the new **file** reached the other desk, a person who had never met them would read it, and **that** was more than what the old system could claim. Whether the council would act was another matter.

中文翻译

第三段弧线的试行只有一个主题：照料。一位居家照护员、一位夜班护士，以及一位养育了四个孩子的家庭主妇，同意接受从未做过这些事的人的采访。“你想知道爱要付出什么代价，”那位照护员说，“把它写进档案，然后来做一班。”

病房里一位病人有一张她丈夫穿黑色套装的合影；她旁边的柜子上放着一枚旧铜币、一瓶药和一封白色信封。“他是一家纺织公司的代理商，”她说，“他笑起来很可爱，欠了很多债。”那年冬天厂里的罢工，是她档案里唯一有人费心记录的事。

访谈转向了传承：母亲传给女儿什么，父亲有什么完全传不下去。“孩子不是存货，”她说，“婚姻也不是结盟。”她与丈夫之间的亲密，挺过了从南方来的流亡、一只空柜台，以及为一切排队的日子。

她邻床的伙伴是一位退休教师；他的好友每周四带着一锅羔羊肉炖菜来，容器上贴着纸标签。“朋友不是肢体，”她说，“你不能砍掉一个，然后说剩下的还完整。”空椅子的恐怖对病房里的每个人都很熟悉，而那位年轻护士对眼泪的敌意，从它自己的方式来说，也是一种深情。

市政内阁的一位女士前来代表议会，穿着套装，皮套里装着一枚镜片。“告诉我你们发现了什么，”她说。“这是我们知道的：一次脉搏、一位女王、草丛里的一条蛇。”她的脉搏很稳；她离开时的背影是一句冷淡的告别。“既然你问了，”曼雅说，“我们发现的是：人们在意写这份档案的人是否能想象他们的生活。”内阁里有一个盟友往往就够了；当新档案送到另一张桌上时，一个从未见过他们的人 would 读它——这已经比旧体系所能声称的更多。议会是否会行动，则是另一回事。

Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
have hæv POS: vt	vt. 有, 怀有, 拿, 进行; aux. 已经 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. have or possess, either in a concrete or an abstract sense; v. have as a feature; v. have a personal or busi...
that ðæt POS: a	a. 那, 那个; conj. 以致, 因为; pron. 那; adv. 那么, 那样 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: pron., a., conj., & As a demonstrative pronoun (pl. Those),; that usually points out, or refers to, a pers...
people 'pi:pl POS: n	n. 人, 人民, 民族, 平民; vt. 使住满人, 居住于 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. (plural) any group of human beings (men or women or children) collectively; n. members of a family line; v. ...
woman 'wʊmən POS: n	n. 女人, 妇女, 女仆; a. 女用的, 女性的, 妇女的; vt. 贬称...为女人, 使成女人腔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an adult female person (as opposed to a man); n. a female person who plays a significant role (wife or mist...
child tʃaɪld POS: n	n. 孩子, 产物, 追随者; [医] 儿童 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a young person of either sex; n. a human offspring (son or daughter) of any age; n. an immature childish per...
home haʊm POS: n	n. 家, 避难所, 故乡; a. 家庭的, 国内的, 打中目标的; adv. 在家, 在本国, 打中目标地; [计] 返回始位 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. where you live at a particular time; n. the country or state or city where you live; n. place where somethin...
friend frend POS: n	n. 朋友, 支持者, 赞助者; [法] 朋友, 友人, 赞助者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person you know well and regard with affection and trust; n. a member of the Religious Society of Friends...
subject 'sʌbdʒekt POS: n	n. 科目, 主题, 臣民, 主语, 题目, (事物的)经受者, 学科, 受治疗者, 原因, 理由; a. 服从的, 易患...的, 隶属的... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the subject matter of a conversation or discussion; n. something (a person or object or scene) selected by...
patient 'peɪjənt POS: n	n. 病人, 承受者; a. 忍耐的, 容忍的, 有耐性的, 坚忍的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who requires medical care; a. enduring trying circumstances with even temper or characterized by s...
love lʌv POS: n	n. 爱, 恋爱, 爱情, 爱好, 性爱; vt. 爱, 爱好, 爱慕; vi. 爱 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a strong positive emotion of regard and affection; n. any object of warm affection or devotion; ; n. a deep...
care keə POS: n	n. 小心, 照料, 忧虑; vi. 关心, 介意; vt. 在意, 喜欢 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the work of providing treatment for or attending to someone or something; n. a cause for feeling concern; n. ...
arm ɑ:m POS: n	n. 手臂, 袖子, 狭长港湾, 武器; vt. 武装, 装备; vi. 武装起来; [计] 异步应答方式; 自动货品销路管理 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a human limb; technically the part of the superior limb between the shoulder and the elbow but commonly us...
worker 'wɜ:kə POS: n	n. 工人, 劳动者; [经] 工人, 劳工, 劳动者 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who works at a specific occupation; n. sterile member of a colony of social insects that forages f...
represent 'reprɪzənt POS: vt	vt. 表现, 表示, 描绘, 讲述, 代表, 象征, 回忆, 再赠送, 再上演; vi. 提出异议 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: v. take the place of or be parallel or equivalent to; v. be representative or typical for; v. be a delegate or...
stock stɒk POS: n	n. 树干, 祖先, 血统, 原料, 备料, 库存, 牲畜, 股票, 股份, 保留剧目; a. 存货的, 常备的, 平凡的, 普通的, 股票... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the capital raised by a corporation through the issue of shares entitling holders to an ownership interest...
agent 'eidʒənt POS: n	n. 代理商, 政府代表, 动原, 媒介; [计] 代理程序 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. an active and efficient cause; capable of producing a certain effect; n. a representative who acts on behal...
strike straɪk POS: n	n. 罢工, 打击, 殴打; vt. 打, 撞击, 冲击, 侵袭, 取消, 结算, 打掉, 罢工, 刺透, 使生根, 遇见; vi. 打, 打... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a group's refusal to work in protest against low pay or bad work conditions; n. an attack that is intended...
file faɪl POS: n	n. 档案, 公文箱, 文件夹, 文件, 卷宗, 锉刀; vi. 列队行进, 用锉刀做; vt. 归档, 申请, 锉, 琢磨; [计] 文件 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a set of related records (either written or electronic) kept together; n. a line of persons or things range...
queen 'kwi:n POS: n	n. 王后, 女王; vt. 立为女王; vi. 做女王 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the only fertile female in a colony of social insects such as bees and ants and termites; its function is...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
cabinet 'kæbɪnɪt POS: n	n. 橱柜, 内阁; a. 内阁的, 细木工做的; [计] 机柜 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a piece of furniture resembling a cupboard with doors and shelves and drawers; for storage or display; n. p...
suit sju:t, su:t POS: n	n. 套装, 诉讼, 请求, 起诉, 套, 组; vt. 适合, 使适应; vi. 合适, 相称 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a set of garments (usually including a jacket and trousers or skirt) for outerwear all of the same fabric...
familiar fe'mɪljə POS: a	a. 熟悉的, 常见的, 亲密的; n. 熟友, 常客 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person attached to the household of a high official (as a pope or bishop) who renders service in return...
lovely 'lʌvli POS: a	a. 可爱的, 有趣的 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: s. appealing to the emotions as well as the eye
bottle 'bɒtl POS: n	n. 瓶子, 酒瓶; vt. 装瓶, 抑制, 围困 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a glass or plastic vessel used for storing drinks or other liquids; typically cylindrical without handles...
emotion i'məʊʃən POS: n	n. 情绪, 激动, 强烈的情感; [医] 情绪, 情感 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. any strong feeling
alliance ə'leɪəns POS: n	n. 联盟, 联合; [法] 同盟, 联盟, 联姻 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the state of being allied or confederated; n. a connection based on kinship or marriage or common interest; ...
ally 'ælaɪ, ə'laɪ POS: n	n. 同盟者, 同盟国, 助手; vt. 使联盟, 使联合, 使有关系; vi. 结盟 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a friendly nation; n. an associate who provides cooperation or assistance; v. become an ally or associate, a...
tail teɪl POS: n	n. 尾部, 后部, 辫子, 随员, 特务, 燕尾服, 踪迹, 限定继承(权); a. 在后面的, 从后面而来的, 限定继承的, 尾部的, ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the posterior part of the body of a vertebrate especially when elongated and extending beyond the trunk or...
terror 'terə POS: n	n. 恐怖, 可怕的人; [医] 惊吓, 惊悸 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who inspires fear or dread; n. a very troublesome child; n. the use of extreme fear in order to coe...
counter 'kaʊntə POS: n	n. 计算器, 计算者, 柜台, 筹码; a. 反方向的, 相反的; adv. 反方向地, 相反地; [计] 计数器; 计数字 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. table consisting of a horizontal surface over which business is transacted; n. game equipment (as a piece o...
companion kəm'pænjən POS: n	n. 朋友, 陪伴, 指南, 升降口围罩; vt. 陪伴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a friend who is frequently in the company of another; n. a traveler who accompanies you; n. one paid to acco...
snake sneɪk POS: n	n. 蛇, 阴险的人; vi. 曲折行进; vt. 迂回, 拉, 急抽 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. limbless scaly elongate reptile; some are venomous; n. a deceitful or treacherous person; n. a tributary of...
lens lenz POS: n	n. 透镜, 镜头, 镜片, 晶状体; vt. 给...摄影 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a transparent optical device used to converge or diverge transmitted light and to form images; n. genus of...
limb lɪm POS: n	n. 四肢, 枝干, 翼, 边缘; vt. 切断...之手足 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. one of the jointed appendages of an animal used for locomotion or grasping: arm; leg; wing; flipper; n. any...
copper 'kɒpə POS: n	n. 铜, 警察; [化] 铜Cu Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a ductile malleable reddish-brown corrosion-resistant diamagnetic metallic element; occurs in various mine...
hostility hɒs'tɪlɪti POS: n	n. 敌意, 敌对, 反对 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a hostile (very unfriendly) disposition; n. a state of deep-seated ill-will; n. the feeling of a hostile per...
affection ə'fekʃən POS: n	n. 影响, 病, 喜爱, 情感, 倾向; [医] 疾患, 病变, 病; 感情 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a positive feeling of liking
buddy 'bʌdi POS: n	n. 好朋友, 伙伴 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a close friend who accompanies his buddies in their activities
lamb læm POS: n	n. 小羊, 羔羊; v. 产羊羔 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. young sheep; n. English essayist (1775-1834); n. a person easily deceived or cheated (especially in financia...
pulse pʌls POS: n	n. 脉冲, 脉搏, 情绪, 意向, 拍子, 豆类; vi. 跳动, 脉跳; vt. 使跳动, 用脉冲调制; [计] 脉冲 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. the rhythmic contraction and expansion of the arteries with each beat of the heart; n. the rate at which th...

Word / Pronunciation	Context meaning / source example
tag tæg POS: n	n. 标签, 附属物, 碎片, 结束语, 口头禅, 附加语, 浑名, 标记, 标记符; vt. 附以签条, 尾随, 添饰, 起浑名, 连接; ... Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a label written or printed on paper, cardboard, or plastic that is attached to something to indicate its o...
inheritance in'heritəns POS: n	n. 遗传, 遗产; [医] 遗传 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. hereditary succession to a title or an office or property; n. that which is inherited; a title or property...
exile 'eksail POS: n	n. 放逐, 流放, 被放逐者; vt. 放逐, 流放, 使背井离乡 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a person who is voluntarily absent from home or country; n. a person who is expelled from home or country b...
intimacy 'intiməsi POS: n	n. 亲密, 熟悉, 亲昵行为(言语); [法] 亲近的行为, 亲密, 隐私 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. close or warm friendship; n. a usually secretive or illicit sexual relationship; n. a feeling of being intimate...
housewife 'hauswaif POS: n	n. 主妇, 家庭妇女 Collocation: — (not independently sourced) Example: n. a wife who manages a household while her husband earns the family income